

Chapter-11

The Verb

There are two major parts of a sentence: **Subject** and **Predicate**. Subject is the person or thing we talk about in a sentence. Predicate is the statement given about the subject. A predicate always starts with a verb.

Study the following table carefully.

Sr. No.	Subject	Predicate	
		Verb	Remaining part of the Predicate
1	Children	are playing	in the park.
2	Rakesh	is writing	a letter.
3	Surbhi	played	with her doll.
4	India	is	a great country.

The word 'verb' has been taken from the Latin word 'verbum' which means 'to say something'.

Definition: A verb is a word that says something about a subject. A verb may tell three things about a subject.

1. It tells us what a subject(s) is. It denotes the existence of a subject in any tense. The forms of 'be' are used to denote existence.

Forms of 'be'	be, is, am, are, was, were, been, being
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- (a) He is my friend. (b) She was a doctor. (c) They were thieves.
(d) You have been a fool. (e) You will be happy. (f) I am very happy today.

Here the verbs 'is', 'was', 'were', 'been', 'be' and 'am' denote existence.

2. It tells us what a subject(s) has/owns/possesses. The forms of 'have' are used to denote possession. The possession may be denoted in any tense.

Forms of 'have'	has, have, had, having
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- (a) I have a car. (c) They will have a problem.
(b) She has a big house. (d) The boy had a blue shirt.

Here the verbs 'have', 'has', 'will have' and 'had' denote possessions.

3. It tells us what a subject(s) does. All action words are verbs. The action may be expressed in any tense.

- (a) Harish waters the plants. (b) The peon rang the bell.
(c) She is laughing. (d) They have been playing football since morning.

Here, the verbs 'waters', 'rang', 'laughing' and 'playing' denote actions.

The Concept of Object

Study the following table carefully.

Sr. No.	Subject	Predicate	
		Verb	Object
1	Children	are playing	cricket.
2	Rakesh	is writing	a letter.
3	The gardener	watered	the plants.

A Noun or a pronouns that receives the action of the verb is called the object. A verb may take more than one object.

Types of Verb

There are three types of verbs.

- ▶ Intransitive Verbs
- ▶ Transitive Verbs
- ▶ Linking Verbs or Verbs of Incomplete Predication

Intransitive Verbs

Study the table given below carefully:

Subject	Verb
Birds	fly.
Stars	twinkle.
She	laughs.
They	smiled.
The windows	broke.
The boy	was sitting.

The verbs 'fly', 'twinkle', 'laughs', 'smiled', 'broke' and 'was sitting' make a complete sense on their own. They don't require any other word to complete their meaning. Since the action denoted by each of these verbs does not pass over to any other word (object), these verbs are called intransitive verbs.

Definition:- An intransitive verb does not take any object after it.

Transitive Verbs

Important Note: The word 'transitive' is derived from the word 'transit' which means 'to pass over' or 'transfer'.

Read the following sentences carefully. You can observe that these sentences seem incomplete unless we add an object to them.

He killed..... (What/whom)	We have informed..... (Whom)
They were helping..... (Whom)	Children like..... (What)
I am reading..... (What)	She teaches.....(What/ Whom)
Open..... (What)	I have completed..... (What)
Karim beats..... (Whom)	She stitched..... (What)

In the above sentences, the verbs don't make a complete sense themselves. They require some other words to complete their meaning. The action denoted by each verb in these sentences passes over to an object. Therefore, these verbs are called transitive verbs.

Definition:- A transitive verb takes an object after it.

Now read the same sentences with objects.

He killed a snake .	We have informed the students .
They were helping the injured .	Children like sweets .
I am reading a story .	She teaches English .
Open your book .	I have completed my homework .
Karim beats me .	She stitched a beautiful dress .

Exercise: Complete the following sentences by supplying an object.

1. My mother has prepared.....
2. Mohan will learn.....

3. He did not receive.....
4. Please, help.....
5. Yesterday I watched.....
6. I want.....
7. The teacher appreciated.....
8. We must respect.....

Transitive Verbs with Double Objects

Read the following sentences carefully. You will observe that the transitive verbs in these sentences have got an object. However, these verbs don't make a complete sense. They require another object to complete their meaning.

1. He gave me
2. The teacher asked him

Now read the same sentences with two objects

1. He gave me a book.
2. The teacher asked him a question.

Each of the sentences given above has two objects. The words, 'me', and 'him' are indirect objects. The words, 'a book', and 'a question' are direct objects.

Exercise: Complete the following sentences with director object.

1. They posted their friends
2. The Principal granted us
3. Mr. Sharma teaches us
4. I promised him
5. The shopkeeper sold him

Read the following pairs of sentences carefully.

1. He gave me a book. He gave a book to me
2. My father bought me a new watch. My father bought a new watch for me.

You can observe that the sentences with two objects can be written in two ways by exchanging the order of the direct and the indirect objects.

Exercise: Rewrite the following sentences by keeping the direct object before the indirect object.

1. My mother cooked us delicious dishes.
.....
2. They posted their friends greeting cards.
.....
3. The Principal granted us leave.
.....
4. Mr. Sharma teaches us English.
.....
5. I promised him my support.
.....

6. My friend brought me a glass of water.

7. The shopkeeper sold him a pair of shoes.

8. My father gifted me a watch.

Transitive Verbs with Object Complement

Some transitive verbs don't make a complete sense even when they are supplied with an object. They require an object complement to complete their meaning. An object complement refers back to the object.

Examples: 1. The teacher appointed **Mohit**.....(what)
2. Success made **him**.....(what)

Now read the same sentences as complete sentences with object as well as object complements.

1. The teacher appointed **Mohit** monitor. 2. Success made **him** arrogant.

Exercise: Complete the following sentences by supplying an object complement.

1. Her parents named her.....
2. She called her servant.....
3. He painted the box.....
4. We found the house.....
5. The judge found the accused.....

Exercise: Underline the verbs in the following sentences and state whether they are transitive or intransitive. Write (T) for transitive and (IT) for intransitive. Mention the object. The first two examples have been done for you.

1. The vase broke. (IT)
2. The boy opened the window. (T) Object: window
3. We attended a party last night.
4. The baby has been sleeping for an hour.
5. The girls are making dolls.
6. The doctor has arrived.
7. A cold breeze was flowing.
8. The boat floated all night.

Linking Verbs

Read the following sentences carefully. You can observe that these sentences are incomplete.

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. I am..... | 4. The rose smells..... |
| 2. They are..... | 5. This book is..... |
| 3. You look..... | 6. He grew..... |

Now read the same sentences as complete sentences as given below.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. I am a <u>teacher</u> . | 4. The rose smells <u>sweet</u> . |
| 2. They are <u>my students</u> . | 5. This book is <u>mine</u> . |
| 3. You look <u>tired</u> . | 6. He grew <u>old</u> . |

In these sentences the underlined words complete the sentences and refer back to the subject. There is no transfer of action. Hence, these words are called subject complements. Since the verbs in these sentences establish a link between the subject and the subject complement, they are called linking verbs or verbs of incomplete predication. The forms of 'be' used as main verbs and verbs like 'look', 'appear', 'seem', 'grow', 'become', 'turn' etc. take a subject complement.

Exercise: Underline the verbs and circle the subject complements in the following sentences.

- | | |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. The milk turned sour. | 6. It seems terrifying. |
| 2. He got angry. | 7. This house has been abandoned. |
| 3. She is beautiful. | 8. Subir has fallen sick. |
| 4. This sum appears difficult. | 9. Amar felt sorry. |
| 5. He became a doctor. | 10. The man got angry. |

Exercise: Underline the verbs in the following sentences. State whether the verbs are transitive, intransitive or linking. Write (T) for transitive, (IT) for intransitive and (L) for linking verbs.

1. The boy threw stones in the pond.
2. He became unconscious.
3. One must respect one's elders.
4. This is Ram's umbrella.
5. The river flowed gracefully through the hills and valleys.
6. The burning train was a horrifying sight.
7. The teacher seems angry today.
8. He thought continuously for hours.
9. Both the brothers turned enemies.
10. The birds are chirping on the trees.

Main Verbs and Auxiliaries (Helping Verbs)

Read the following sentences and observe the verbs carefully.

1. I **talked** to my friend.
2. I was **talking** to my friend.
3. We **water** the plants.
4. We have **watered** the plants.

In the above sentences, the verbs talked, talking, water and watered are called **main verbs** as they express the main action. The verbs 'was' and 'have' in the above sentences are also verbs, but these verbs are called **helping verbs** because they help the main verbs.

Exercise: Underline the helping verbs and circle the main verbs in the following sentences.

1. God is our heavenly father.
2. The programme will begin soon.
3. He does his work very carefully.
4. Rohan has many friends.
5. They will be watching a movie.
6. Sudha and Madhu are sisters.
7. The teacher will have been teaching for two hours.
8. He was being beaten by the police.
9. Are you kidding with me?
10. Have you ever been to the Delhi?
11. They should not disturb others.
12. Could you tell me the way to the railway station?
13. What would you like to have?
14. It may rain today.
15. How dare you talk to me like this?

Conjugation of Verbs

Writing different forms of verbs is called conjugation. Study the table given below carefully.

Present Form (I Form)	Past Form (II Form)	Past Participle Form (III Form)	Present Participle Form (I Form+ing)
be (is, am, are)	was, were	been	being
begin	began	begun	beginning
cut	cut	cut	cutting
do	did	done	doing
dream	dreamt	dreamt	dreaming
eat	ate	eaten	eating
go	went	gone	going
have, has	had	had	having
play	played	played	playing
throw	threw	thrown	throwing

Regular Verbs (Weak Verbs)

The verbs that form their past form and past participle form by adding ‘-ed’, ‘-d’, or ‘-t’ are called regular verbs or weak verbs.

Examples:

Present Form	Past Form	Past Participle Forms	Present Participle Forms
build	built	built	building
play	played	played	playing
talk	talked	talked	talking

Some weak verbs have the same forms as present, past and past participle form.

Examples:

Present Form	Past Form	Past Participle Form	Present Participle Form
burst	burst	burst	bursting
cast	cast	cast	casting
cost	cost	cost	costing
cut	cut	cut	cutting
hit	hit	hit	hitting
hurt	hurt	hurt	hurting
let	let	let	letting
put	put	put	putting
set	set	set	setting
shed	shed	shed	shedding
shut	shut	shut	shutting
spread	spread	spread	spreading
thrust	thrust	thrust	thrusting
upset	upset	upset	upsetting

Irregular Verbs (Strong Verbs)

The verbs that form their past form and past participle form by changing the inside vowel of their present form are called irregular verbs or strong verbs.

Examples:

Present Form	Past Form	Past Participle Form	Present Participle Form
see	saw	seen	seeing
fly	flew	flown	flying
choose	chose	chosen	choosing
sell	sold	sold	selling

Forms of Some Frequently Used Verbs

Present Form	Past Form	Past Participle Form	Present Participle Form
arise	arose	arisen	arising
abide	abode	abode	abiding
awake	awoke	awaken	awaking
be (is, am, are)	was, were	been	being
bear	born	born	bearing
bear	born	borne	bearing
beat	beat	beaten	beating
become	became	become	becoming
bind	bound	bound	binding
bid	bade	bidden	biding
bite	bit	bitten	biting
blow	blew	blown	blowing
break	broke	broken	breaking
bring	brought	brought	bringing
burn	burnt	burnt	burning
buy	bought	bought	buying
catch	caught	caught	catching
climb	climbed	climbed	climbing
come	came	come	coming

dig	dug	dug	digging
do	did	done	doing
draw	drew	drawn	drawing
drink	drank	drunk	drinking
deal	dealt	dealt	dealing
dream	dreamt	dreamt	dreaming
feed	fed	fed	feeding
feel	felt	felt	feeling
fall	fell	fallen	falling
fell (to cut trees)	felled	felled	felling
fight	fought	fought	fighting
find	found	found	finding
flee	fled	fled	fleeing
fling	flung	flung	flinging
flow	flowed	flowed	flowing
fly	flew	flown	flying
forget	forgot	forgotten	forgetting
freeze	froze	frozen	freezing
forsake	forsook	forsaken	forsaking
get	got	got	getting
give	gave	given	giving
grow	grew	grown	growing
hide	hid	hidden	hiding
hang	hung	hung	hanging
hang	hanged	hanged	hanging
hold	held	held	holding
kneel	knelt	knelt	kneeling
knit	knit, knitted	knit, knitted	knitting
keep	kept	kept	keeping
know	knew	known	knowing
lead	led	led	leading
lie	lay	lain	lying
lie	lied	lied	lying
lay	laid	laid	laying
lend	lent	lent	lending
lose	lost	lost	losing
lead	led	led	leading
make	made	made	making
mean	meant	meant	meaning
mar	marred	marred	marring
pay	paid	paid	paying
pray	prayed	prayed	praying
ride	rode	ridden	riding
read	read	read	reading
ring	rang	rung	ringing
run	ran	run	running
send	sent	sent	sending
sow	sowed	sowed	sowing
spend	spent	spent	spending
sit	sat	sat	sitting
speak	spoke	spoken	speaking
spell	spelt	spelt	spelling
sweep	swept	swept	sweeping

shake	shook	shaken	shaking
shine	shone	shone	shining
sink	sank	sunk	sinking
swear	swore	sworn	swearing
swim	swam	swum	swimming
shoot	shot	shot	shooting
sling	slung	slung	slinging
saw	sawed	sawed	sawing
shear	sheared	sheared	shearing
spoil	spoilt	spoilt	spoiling
strive	strove	striven	striving
stand	stood	stood	standing
swell	swelled	swelled	swelling
take	took	taken	taking
talk	talked	talked	talking
teach	taught	taught	teaching
think	thought	thought	thinking
tread	trod	trodden	treading
undergo	underwent	undergone	undergoing
win	won	won	winning
weep	wept	wept	weeping
weave	wove	woven	weaving
wed	wedded	wedded	wedding
wind	wound	wound	winding
wound	wounded	wounded	wounding
weaken	weakened	weakened	weakening
weigh	weighed	weighed	weighing
write	wrote	written	writing
yield	yielded	yielded	yielding

Exercise: Fill in the blanks by using the correct forms of the given verbs.

1. We(visit) the Taj Mahal last year.
2. I have.....(complete) my homework.
3. The children.....(be).....(play) in the playground at that time.
4. My friend (sing) very well.
5.(do) you(go) to market yesterday?
6. He(have) never.....(be) to a zoo.
7. They have.....(write) a letter.
8. My friend.....(polish) his shoes every day.
9. I.....(be, help) my mother in the kitchen when my father came home.
10. The clever fox.....(think) of a plan.
11. I.....(go) to school on foot.
12. Once upon a time, there.....(be) a king.